

Summary of Science

(All text and picture from [Wikipedia](#), the free encyclopedia)

Science (from the Latin *scientia*, meaning "knowledge") is an enterprise that builds and organizes knowledge in the form of testable explanations and predictions about the natural world. An older meaning still in use today is that of Aristotle, for whom scientific knowledge was a body of reliable knowledge that can be logically and rationally explained.

Since classical antiquity science as a type of knowledge was closely linked to philosophy, the way of life dedicated to discovering such knowledge. And into early modern times the two words, "science" and "philosophy", were sometimes used interchangeably in the English language. By the 17th century, "natural philosophy" (which is today called "natural science") could be considered separately from "philosophy" in general. But "science" continued to also be used in a broad sense denoting reliable knowledge about a topic, in the same way it is still used in

modern terms such as library science or political science.

The more narrow sense of

"science" that is

common today

developed as a part

of science became a

distinct enterprise of

defining "laws of nature", based

on early examples such as

Kepler's laws, Galileo's laws, and

Newton's laws of motion. In this

period it became more common

to refer to natural philosophy as

"natural science". Over the course

of the 19th century, the word

"science" became increasingly

associated with the disciplined

study of the natural world

including physics, chemistry,

geology and biology. This

sometimes left the study of

human thought and society in a

linguistic limbo, which was

resolved by classifying these

areas of academic study as social

science. Similarly, several other

major areas of disciplined study

and knowledge exist today under

the general rubric of "science",

such as formal science and

applied science.

